

Nirvan Sutra

Chapter 8

A Glimpse of Nirvan

Final chapter · reference text for seekers

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First Section - The Last Grip Must Also Be Released

From the previous chapter: becoming lighter than words

By now the seeker has walked a long way.

The body has been seen.

The mind has been seen.

The experiencer has been understood.

The direction of Sakshi-bhav has been touched.

The nature of Maya and the world has been explored.

The layers of Ahankar have been observed.

Neti-neti has made wrong identifications lighter.

The Mahavakyas have been heard.

The direction of Turiya has been understood.

And the subtle point of the unknowable has also been touched - that which the mind cannot grasp as an object, because it is the very basis of all knowing.

Now the final chapter brings a very gentle but very necessary turn.

The words that helped the seeker until now must also be placed in their right position.

The word Sakshi was useful.

The word Atma was useful.

The word Brahman was useful.

Maya, Ahankar, Neti-neti, Turiya - all these words were signs on the path.

But do not turn the sign into the destination.

A map shows the way, but the map is not the destination.

A boat helps one cross the river, but after reaching the shore the boat is not carried on the head.

Medicine is helpful in illness, but after health returns, medicine is not made into an identity.

In the same way, every chapter, every word, every practice in Nirvan Sutra is here to bring the seeker back within. If the seeker clings to these words and says, "Now this is my identity," then the journey has become another form of holding.

So the spirit of this final chapter is simple:

**Even understanding must become light.
The path must be given its right place.
Even the idea of Nirvan must be released.**

What is Nirvan?

In this course, Nirvan does not mean some faraway supernatural event. It is not a shining experience. It is not a special state in which the seeker becomes permanently fixed. It is not a spiritual title.

The simple meaning of Nirvan is this: the cooling of the fire of wrong identification.

When the seeker takes the body-mind to be "I," there is constant holding inside.

When experiences are treated as final truth, there is inner tension.

When Ahankar protects role, image, and story, there is pressure.

When spiritual practice itself becomes identity, there is subtle heaviness.

When even "I have understood" or "I want Nirvan" becomes a claim, holding continues.

A glimpse of Nirvan appears when this holding becomes a little loose.

It is an extinguishing - not of life, but of false gripping.

It is a quietening - not of the body, but of the restlessness of identity.

It is an ending - not of experiences, but of the burden of the "I" that clings to them.

Remember this carefully: Nirvan does not mean leaving life.

Nirvan means seeing life without the heavy grip of false identity.

The body will remain.

The mind will move.

Emotions will arise.

Relationships will continue.

Work will continue.

The world will appear.

Practice will also continue.

But within, there will slowly be a clarity: "I am not merely this limited center made of passing experiences."

This is the direction of Nirvan.

Giving the experiencer its right place

Now the experiencer must be understood very carefully.

Do not treat the experiencer as if it were the same as Ahankar. The experiencer is not an enemy. The experiencer is the center at the level of experience where an experience is known as "my experience."

When there is pain in the body, someone says, "I have pain."

When sorrow arises in the mind, someone says, "I feel sorrow."

When joy comes, someone says, "I experienced joy."

When peace comes in meditation, someone says, "I experienced peace."

This is the experiencer.

In practical life, it has a place. If the body needs treatment, one has to say, "I have pain." If something is to be shared, one may say, "I experienced this." In communication, learning, practice, and healing, the language of the experiencer continues.

The problem is not that the experiencer appears.

The problem begins when the experiencer turns experiences into final identity. When "I felt sorrow" becomes "I am sorrow itself." When "I succeeded" becomes "I am superior." When "I experienced peace" becomes "I have awakened."

This is where Ahankar joins.

So understand clearly:

The experiencer is the center of experience.

Ahankar is the hardened identity built out of that experience.

The experiencer may say, "I experienced sorrow."

Ahankar says, "My story of sorrow is who I am."

The experiencer may say, "I found peace in meditation."

Ahankar says, "My practice is special."

The experiencer may say, "I had a glimpse of understanding."

Ahankar says, "I am ahead of others."

The direction of Nirvan does not fight the experiencer. It makes the experiencer transparent. Experiences happen, but a hard "I" is not formed out of them.

Do not turn Nirvan into an experience

Now comes a very subtle point.

The seeker often asks, "What will the experience of Nirvan be like?" The mind wants a definite sign - some special peace, some light, some permanent bliss, some experience through which it can say, "Yes, this is Nirvan."

But whatever comes as experience will be an experience.

Peace came - it was known.

Joy came - it was known.

Silence came - it was known.

Emptiness came - it was known.

A deep state came - it was known.

A special sensation came - it was known.

Whatever is known is something that comes and goes. It may be a glimpse, but it is not Nirvan itself.

Nirvan is not the name of an experience. Nirvan is the quieting of the wrong grip around experiences.

This is very important.

If the seeker takes an experience to be Nirvan, then the seeker will begin to cling to that experience. The mind will ask, "Why did that state not return?" "Where did my experience go?" "Has my practice fallen?" "Have I lost something?"

See - the grip has returned.

Nirvan is not in grasping experience.

Nirvan is in knowing experiences as they come and go, without making them final identity.

Do not make Nirvan Sutra into another grip

This course gives direction to the seeker. But in the final chapter it must be clearly understood that Nirvan Sutra is also a means, not the final holding.

If a seeker says, "I am a seeker of Nirvan Sutra, therefore I am special," that is a new identity.

If someone says, "I have completed all eight chapters, therefore I have knowledge," that is the mind's hurry.

If someone says, "Now I know all the right words, so the journey is over," that is information, not stability.

If someone says, "I have the correct lexicon, therefore I have understood," then words have become identity.

Words are necessary. Correct words reduce confusion. Stable definitions give the seeker direction. But words are not truth. Words point toward truth.

The word Sakshi is not Sakshi.

The word Atma is not Atma.

The word Brahman is not Brahman.

The word Turiya is not Turiya.

The word Nirvan is not Nirvan.

Words bring you to the doorway. Entry happens in silence.

Therefore, in the final chapter, the seeker must not run away from words, but must also not become trapped in words.

This course is a lamp.

The lamp shows the path.

The seeker must walk the path.

And in the end, even the light should not be claimed as "mine."

The final subtle grip of practice

Practice itself can sometimes become a grip.

First a person forms identity from the world. Then practice begins. Now the same person can start forming identity from practice.

"I practice regularly."

"I remain in Sakshi."

"I know Neti-neti."

"I understand the Mahavakyas."

"I know the direction of Turiya."

"I am on the path of Nirvan."

These sentences can be useful if they are only practical language. But if specialness, pride, comparison, or security becomes attached to them, then practice itself becomes a burden.

The direction of Nirvan does not reject practice. It makes practice light.

Practice, but do not create a hard identity of the practitioner.
Return to Sakshi-bhav, but do not make an image of "I am the witness."
Practice Neti-neti, but do not call others ignorant.
Listen to the Mahavakyas, but do not turn them into announcements.
Understand the direction of Turiya, but do not claim any state.
Hear the word Nirvan, but do not make it a new achievement.

The aim of practice is not to build the image of the seeker.
The aim of practice is to make the seeker's grip lighter.

Does this mean nothing should matter?

The mind may ask, "If all holding is to be released, does nothing matter?"

No. That would also be a misunderstanding.

Life matters.

The body must be cared for.

The mind must be understood.

Emotions must be met with compassion.

Relationships must be lived with love.

Work must be done honestly.

Practice must be kept sincere.

Words must be respected.

The guidance of the Guru must be heard with seriousness.

But none of these should become final identity.

Hold the flower in the hand, but do not close the fist around it.

Live relationships, but do not turn them into possession.

Practice, but do not turn it into a claim.

Listen to knowledge, but do not turn it into Ahankar.

Walk toward Nirvan, but do not turn it into the restlessness of "I must attain it."

Life is not to be rejected.

The false stamp upon life is to be removed.

The first glimpse of Nirvan

A glimpse of Nirvan does not necessarily arrive as a grand miracle. It often appears in a very ordinary moment.

Someone criticizes you. Hurt arises inside. Earlier you would react immediately. This time you pause for one moment. Hurt is known. The language of the experienter arises - "I felt hurt." Then you see that Ahankar wants to turn it into a story. A little space opens.

That is a glimpse.

Someone praises you. The mind becomes happy. Earlier you would swell with it. This time joy comes, but there is also a quiet seeing - "The experience of praise is happening." You do not turn it into a new identity.

That is a glimpse.

Meditation does not bring peace. Earlier you would become disappointed. This time you see, "Restlessness is known. The story that practice is bad is arising." You do not blame yourself.

That is a glimpse.

Possessiveness appears in a relationship. Earlier you called it love. This time you see, "This is fear mixed with love." Love becomes a little clearer.

That is a glimpse.

A glimpse of Nirvan does not mean experiences have ended. It means the identity built out of experiences has become a little lighter.

The final freedom: freedom from spiritual concepts too

The seeker is not to be free only from worldly concepts. The seeker must also become free from the grip of spiritual concepts.

"I am a seeker" - this too is ultimately a role.

"I am Sakshi" - if this becomes only a thought, it too must be seen.

"I have understood Neti-neti" - this can also become identity.

"I am Brahman" - this can become a slogan in the hands of Ahankar.

"I am in Turiya" - this can become a claim.

"I want Nirvan" - this too can become the desire of the experienter.

"I am a seeker of Nirvan Sutra" - this too can become a subtle image.

In final freedom, all of this is seen.

Not rejected.

Not suppressed.

Not disrespected.

Simply placed in its right place.

They are lamps on the path.

But the light of knowing is prior to them.

The seeker must become so light that words can be used without being trapped in words. Practice can be done without being trapped in the image of the practitioner. The direction of Nirvan can be walked without being bound by the idea of Nirvan.

This is the ground of the final chapter.

Summary of this section

In this first section, we set the direction of the final chapter.

The chapter is called **A Glimpse of Nirvan**, because the point here is not a distant achievement, but the quieting of the grip of identity.

Nirvan means the cooling of the fire of wrong identification.

It is not the end of life; it is the lightening of grasping.

It is not the end of experiences; it is the loosening of hard identity around them.

It does not fight the experiencer; it gives the experiencer its right place.

It sees the subtle layers of Ahankar.

It does not turn the teachings of Nirvan Sutra into another grip.

It respects words while moving beyond words.

In the next section, we will see how the glimpse of Nirvan appears in everyday life - in the pause before reaction, in openness within relationships, in ease within action, in compassion within sorrow, and in lightness within practice.

Practice for today

Today, look at one spiritual concept with which your identity may be getting connected.

It may be a thought such as:

"I am a seeker."

"I understand Sakshi."

"I want knowledge."

"I have practiced a lot."

"I want Nirvan."

"I should have a special experience."

"I am on this path, so I am different."

Do not reject the thought.

Do not suppress it.

Simply see it.

Then ask three questions:

Is this concept a tool, or is it becoming identity?

Is there lightness here, or grip?

Can I see this spiritual "I" too?

Then gently say:

"This too is a known concept.

It has its respect, but it is not my final nature.

Let this too become light."

From here, the glimpse of final freedom begins.

Second Section - The Glimpse of Nirvan in Everyday Life

From the previous section: recognizing the glimpse in life

In the previous section we saw that the spirit of the final chapter is not to create another achievement, but to release the last grip as well.

The seeker has used many words on the path - body, mind, experiencer, Sakshi, Maya, Ahankar, Neti-neti, Mahavakya, Turiya, Nirvan. These words have helped. But the final clarity is not to cling to them. A word is a pointer, not the truth itself.

A glimpse of Nirvan appears when grip becomes loose - the grip of the world, the grip of spiritual concepts, the grip of experience, and even the grip of "I must get something."

Now the question is:

How does this glimpse appear in daily life?

Does it come only in meditation?

Does it come only in deep silence?

Does it come only through some special spiritual experience?

No.

The glimpse of Nirvan can appear in ordinary life. Often it appears in very small moments - in a pause, in a seeing, in not becoming the old reaction, in a story becoming a little loose, in compassion, in a silence where there used to be noise.

Now we will learn to recognize these glimpses.

The difference between reaction and response

In everyday life, the first glimpse often appears in the space between reaction and response.

Reaction is immediate. Someone says something, and the mind wants to answer at once. Someone criticizes, and defense arises. Someone ignores you, and hurt arises. Someone praises you, and pride arises.

In reaction, the experiencer becomes active very quickly.

"I was hurt."

"I must answer."

"My respect is gone."

"I must prove myself right."

"I must hold."

"I must protect myself."

All this may arise naturally. There is no need to condemn it. Practice does not mean that the energy of reaction will never arise. Practice means that the reaction can be known as it arises.

A glimpse of Nirvan appears when a small space opens between reaction and response.

A harsh word is heard.

Anger rises.

The body tightens.

The mind prepares an answer.

But at that very moment there is a little seeing - "Anger is rising."

That is the glimpse.

You did not suppress anger.

You did not blame yourself.

You did not immediately turn the other person into an enemy.

You simply saw.

Then the response that comes is different. It may still have clarity. It may still have a boundary. It may still say "no." But it is no longer blind reaction.

This is the glimpse of Nirvan in life - a little space in the speed of gripping.

Not drowning in sorrow, but knowing sorrow

Sorrow will come in life. There will be hurt in relationships. There may be pain in the body. The mind may feel heavy. Someone dear may go away. A plan may fail. An old memory may return.

A glimpse of Nirvan does not mean sorrow ends.

If someone says, "I have spiritual understanding, so I should not feel sorrow," this is a new grip. It makes practice hard and unnatural.

When sorrow arises, give it space. Do not suppress it. Do not cover it with spiritual words. Do not make it small by saying, "This is only Maya." Sorrow is present in experience; therefore it must be known honestly.

But do not make sorrow the final identity.

"Sorrow is arising."

"The body feels heavy."

"The mind is making a story."

"The experiencer is saying - this happened to me."

"All this is being known."

This seeing is very tender.

Earlier sorrow would come, and the seeker would become sorrow. Now sorrow comes, and the seeker can see that sorrow is in experience. In this seeing there is not cold distance, but compassion.

To know sorrow is not to escape sorrow.

To know sorrow is to bring light to sorrow.

Where this light enters, the glimpse of Nirvan is present.

Not clinging to happiness either

Just as drowning in sorrow is bondage, clinging to happiness is also bondage.

Happiness came. Praise came. Work succeeded. Love was felt in relationship. Peace came in meditation. Joy arose inside. All this is beautiful. Do not reject it. If beauty comes in life, experience it. Be grateful.

But remain watchful - do not turn happiness into identity.

When happiness comes, the experiencer may say, "Let this remain."

Ahankar may say, "I am special."

The mind may say, "I want this state again."

The seeker may say, "I have received an experience."

Here the grip begins.

A glimpse of Nirvan can appear within happiness too, when happiness comes and is not held.

"Joy is arising."

"Praise has come."

"The mind is pleased."

"There is an experience of peace."

"This too is being known."

This seeing does not reduce happiness. It makes happiness cleaner. There is less fear in it. The seeker no longer wants to bind it. It is allowed to come and go.

Identification becomes loose in sorrow - glimpse.

Grasping becomes loose in happiness - glimpse.

Both point toward freedom.

The glimpse of Nirvan in relationships

Relationships are the most living field of practice. Here there is love, and also expectation. There is closeness, and also hurt. There is understanding, and also confusion. Therefore the glimpse of Nirvan is very important here.

When someone close does not behave according to your wish, grip becomes visible.

When someone does not give enough importance, the hunger for recognition arises.

When someone criticizes you, concern about image arises.

When someone becomes distant, the fear of loneliness arises.

Earlier the seeker said, "You hurt me."

Now there can be a little seeing - "Hurt is arising, and my expectation is also visible."

Earlier one said, "You are mine, so you must be like this."

Now one can see - "There is control mixed with love."

Earlier one said, "Understand me."

Now one can also ask - "Am I able to hear the other person?"

This change is very deep.

A glimpse of Nirvan does not make relationships cold. It makes love cleaner. When grip lessens, there is more space in love. When control lessens, respect grows. When the hurt of the experiencer is seen, dialogue becomes possible.

The glimpse of Nirvan in relationship means:

Love remains, grip becomes lighter.

Boundary remains, hardness becomes less.

Truth remains, blame becomes less.
Closeness remains, control becomes less.
Compassion remains, self-deception becomes less.
This is the direction of a freer relationship.

The glimpse of Nirvan in work and action

Work is a part of life. Someone runs a family, someone runs a business, someone has a job, someone serves, someone does spiritual work. Running away from action is not freedom.

But making identity out of action is bondage.

Work succeeded - "I am successful."

Work failed - "I am a failure."

People appreciated - "I am great."

People ignored - "I have no value."

A glimpse of Nirvan appears when work is done with complete sincerity, but the result is not made into final identity.

The seeker works hard.

Plans.

Learns.

Corrects mistakes.

Takes responsibility.

But within, there is slowly this clarity: "Action is happening. A result will come. Joy or disappointment will arise. But I am not merely the result."

This does not make work weak. It makes work cleaner. Fear reduces, display reduces, comparison reduces. The seeker works because it is to be done, because it is right, because it is service, because life asks for it - not merely to prove identity.

Where there is honesty in action and lightness in result, there is a glimpse of Nirvan.

The glimpse of Nirvan in spiritual practice

The glimpse also appears in practice, but the seeker often misunderstands it.

The seeker thinks practice is good only when peace comes.

Meditation is successful only when thoughts are few.

Knowledge is real only when a special experience comes.

Progress is real only when stability is always present.

This expectation makes practice heavy.

A glimpse of Nirvan appears when the seeker does not turn practice into another grip.

Today many thoughts came in meditation - they were known.

Today peace came - it was known.

Today restlessness was present - it was known.

Today nothing special happened - the thought "nothing happened" was also known.

Today deep understanding came - it too was known.

Today Ahankar said "I am progressing" - that too was known.

Practice is no longer a way to collect experiences. It becomes a way of making identity lighter.

The seeker practices, but does not build the image of a practitioner.

Understands, but does not make the claim of a knower.

Returns, but does not make returning an achievement.

This is the glimpse of Nirvan in practice.

Returning to simplicity

The glimpse of Nirvan does not come to make the seeker extraordinary. It brings the seeker back to simplicity.

This is very important.

Ahankar wants to become special even on the spiritual path. It wants its experience to be different, its state to be high, its identity to be special, and others to recognize it.

But in the direction of Nirvan, the seeker becomes simpler.

Food is eaten as food is to be eaten.

Words are spoken as needed.

Work is done as action.

Rest is taken as the body needs.

Practice is done as a return within.

Love is expressed as the heart naturally moves.

There is less display. Less announcement. Less desire to prove one's state.

There is deep dignity in simplicity. When the seeker no longer needs to look special, truthfulness becomes easier.

A glimpse of Nirvan does not make ordinary life small. It reveals the silence hidden in ordinary life.

Compassion becomes deeper

One important sign of the glimpse of Nirvan is compassion.

If someone's spiritual understanding is making them distant from the sorrow of others, something is incomplete. If they say, "Everything is Maya, so sorrow has no meaning," the heart is not yet open. If they say, "I am Sakshi, nothing affects me," it may be emotional defense, not Sakshi-bhav.

True understanding deepens compassion.

When the seeker sees how the grip around experience becomes suffering, the suffering of others is understood more deeply. When the pain of the experiencer is seen within oneself, there is more sensitivity toward the pain of others. When the layers of Ahankar are seen within oneself, hatred toward the Ahankar of others becomes less.

One sees: everyone is caught in their own identity, fear, story, and longing.

Seeing this should not create hardness. It should create compassion.

In the glimpse of Nirvan, compassion is greater than indifference.

This compassion is not weak emotion; it is a clear heart.

Where clarity and compassion come together, the glimpse is deeper.

Lightness: the quietest sign

One of the simplest signs of the glimpse of Nirvan is lightness.

This is not physical lightness, but the lightness of identity.

Earlier criticism felt very heavy; now there is a little space.

Earlier praise made you swell; now there is gratitude but less grip.

Earlier sorrow became a whole story; now sorrow is present but the story is lighter.
Earlier meditation without experience created disappointment; now seeing is possible.

Earlier the "I" had to be protected everywhere; now there is a little rest.

This lightness is important.

The glimpse of Nirvan does not always come as great light, divine experience, or a miraculous event. Sometimes it is only this: what used to bind does not bind as strongly now.

Less bondage - glimpse.

Looser grip - glimpse.

Less claim - glimpse.

More simplicity - glimpse.

Summary of this section

In this second section, we saw how the glimpse of Nirvan appears in everyday life.

It appears in the pause between reaction and response.

It appears in knowing sorrow instead of suppressing it.

It appears in allowing happiness to come and go without clinging.

It appears in seeing the difference between love and grip in relationships.

It appears in honesty in work and lightness in result.

It appears when the hunger for experiences in practice becomes less.

It appears in simplicity, compassion, and inner softness.

The glimpse of Nirvan is not in escaping life.

It is in the quieting of grip in the middle of life.

In the next section, we will see how this glimpse can be understood as freedom while living in the world - ease in action, compassion in relationship, and the recognition of the unshaken basis within.

Practice for today

Today choose one ordinary event in which you usually react.

It may be criticism, a message, a delay, disagreement, praise, a work result, or a small matter in a relationship.

During or after that event, sit quietly and see:

What was my first reaction?

What grip was behind that reaction - respect, control, love, safety, recognition, or specialness?

Could there have been a little space between reaction and response?

Then gently say:

"This is the practice of life.

Here the grip is seen.

Here the glimpse is possible."

Even if one moment of pause is seen, do not consider it small.

That is a doorway to inner freedom.

Third Section - Freedom While Living in the World

From the previous section: stabilizing the glimpse in life

In the previous section we saw that a glimpse of Nirvan does not come only through special meditation states. It can appear in the ordinary moments of life - in the pause between reaction and response, in knowing sorrow instead of suppressing it, in allowing happiness to come and go, in recognizing the difference between love and grip, in work done sincerely and results held lightly.

Now the question is:

Will this glimpse remain only a moment, or can it slowly become the direction of life?

Here we speak of freedom while living in the world.

This freedom is not about externally abandoning life. It is about the inner grip becoming lighter. The seeker lives the same life - family, relationships, work, body, mind, society, practice - but the identity within these things slowly becomes lighter.

The seeker remains in the world, yet the world does not hold the seeker with the same heaviness.

Experiences happen, yet they are not made into final identity.

Relationships continue, yet the demand that relationships complete the self becomes weaker.

Action continues, yet the result is not used as a stamp of self-worth.

This is the direction of freedom while living in the world.

Freedom does not mean running away

Many seekers connect freedom with escape.

They feel, "If I am truly free, I will have nothing to do with anyone. No relationship, no responsibility, no work, no society, no sorrow, no happiness."

This understanding is incomplete.

Running away from life is not freedom. Sometimes running away can become another grip. A seeker may leave the world, but carry the same story, Ahankar, spiritual image, and hunger for experiences inside. The place outside changes, but the grip within remains.

Living in the world is also not bondage if the identity is clear. Someone can live with family and still become lighter within. Someone can work and still return to Sakshi-bhav. Someone can be in relationship and still see love apart from possession. Someone can practice and not become trapped in the image of a practitioner.

Therefore freedom means: the identity within changes.

Outside, life continues.

Inside, grip loosens.

Outside, action happens.

Inside, doership becomes lighter.

Outside, relationships remain.

Inside, control becomes less.

Outside, experiences arise.

Inside, the identity attached to them becomes less.

This is the direction of real freedom.

The experiencer becomes transparent

In this journey, giving the experiencer its right place is very important.

The experiencer is necessary at the level of experience. Experiences happen in life. The body feels pain, thoughts arise, emotions arise, learning happens, relationships form. In practical life, the seeker says, "I experienced this," "I feel sorrow," "I am understanding this."

This language will continue.

But in the direction of Nirvan, the experiencer slowly becomes transparent.

Earlier, the experiencer would catch every experience and make a story.

Now an experience happens, but a hard identity is not formed immediately.

Earlier, "I felt sorrow" quickly became "I am a sorrowful person."

Now sorrow arises, the experiencer says "there is sorrow," and Sakshi knows it.

Earlier, "I succeeded" quickly became "I am great."

Now success comes, joy arises, and seeing also remains.

Earlier, "I found peace" quickly became "I have progressed."

Now peace comes, but it too is known as experience.

This is transparency.

The experiencer does not vanish. It remains in practical life. But its grip does not harden into Ahankar. Experiences can be shared, learned from, and lived, but they do not become a permanent "I."

In the glimpse of Nirvan, the experiencer becomes light.

Action continues, doership becomes light

One great sign of freedom while living is this: action continues, but doership becomes light.

Action means doing what is to be done - feeding the body, caring for family, working, serving, learning, speaking, listening, deciding, correcting. All this is part of life.

Doership means, "I am doing everything," "Nothing can happen without me," "The result is my identity," "I must get the credit," "If the work fails, I am broken."

Action is necessary.

Doership becomes bondage.

In the direction of Nirvan, the seeker does not run away from action. Action is done with more clarity. But inwardly it is seen that action happens through many causes - body, mind, circumstance, time, support, nature, society, opportunity, habit. Still, in practical life, responsibility must be carried.

The seeker makes effort, but does not place the whole self upon the result.

The seeker learns, but does not destroy oneself because of a mistake.

The seeker respects success, but does not make it a crown of Ahankar.

The seeker serves, but does not turn service into greatness.

Where action is clear and doership is light, the glimpse of Nirvan is entering life.

Relationships remain, grip becomes less

Freedom in relationships is a very deep matter.

Freedom does not mean the seeker stops loving. It does not mean there is no connection. That would make the heart dry.

Freedom in relationship means: love remains, grip becomes less.

Closeness remains, control becomes less.

Listening remains, imposing one's story becomes less.

Boundary remains, hardness becomes less.

Compassion remains, self-forgetfulness does not.

When the seeker loves someone, expectation is often mixed with love. "Understand me," "Be according to my wish," "Never hurt me," "Always give me importance."

This is the human level. Do not condemn it. But see it.

In the direction of Nirvan, the seeker learns to clean love.

The seeker sees, "This is love, and also a need for security is mixed with it."

The seeker sees, "This is care, but control is mixed with it."

The seeker sees, "This is closeness, but fear of losing is also present."

Seeing purifies love.

Relationships become more alive when there is less possession and more presence. The other person is no longer used only to fill one's inner lack. Love receives some sky.

This is the glimpse of Nirvan in relationships.

Maturity with sorrow

Freedom while living does not mean sorrow will never come. Sorrow will come. Loss will happen. The body may become ill. Loved ones will change. Relationships may grow distant. Plans may break. The mind may become heavy.

The glimpse of Nirvan does not erase sorrow; it brings maturity with sorrow.

Earlier sorrow came and the seeker became sorrow. Now sorrow comes and the seeker can gently see, "There is sorrow. The body is heavy. The mind is making a story. The experiencer is calling it mine. All this is being known."

There is compassion in this seeing.

Do not make sorrow small by saying, "Nothing happened."

Do not cover sorrow with spiritual sentences.

Do not keep holding sorrow forever as a story.

Know sorrow.
Give it space.
Learn from it.
Return to Sakshi within it.

Where sorrow is known honestly and yet does not become final identity, there is a deep glimpse of freedom.

Maturity with happiness

Maturity with happiness is as necessary as maturity with sorrow.

When happiness comes, the seeker wants to hold it. "Let this remain," "Let this come again," "Let this be my state," "Let this prove my practice."

Here happiness becomes bondage.

In the direction of Nirvan, happiness is also experienced cleanly.

Joy comes - welcome.
Love comes - gratitude.
Peace comes - rest.
Success comes - gladness.

But there is less gripping.

The seeker sees, "This too is an experience. It is beautiful. It will come and go. It is not to be held."

When clinging to happiness lessens, happiness becomes purer. It carries less fear, less greed, less restlessness for repetition.

Then happiness also becomes a doorway to practice.

Practice becomes natural

When the glimpse of Nirvan enters life, practice is no longer a hard project. It becomes the natural direction of life.

Earlier the seeker thought, "I have to practice, I have to progress, I have to get experiences, I need knowledge." This effort is useful in the beginning. But if it becomes heavy, practice itself becomes a burden.

In maturity, practice becomes natural.

Seeing while walking.

Listening while speaking.

Keeping compassion in sorrow.

Not gripping happiness.

Keeping clarity in action.

Smiling when a layer of Ahankar appears.

Returning to Sakshi-bhav.

Living Neti-neti gently.

Making the Mahavakyas a quiet remembrance, not an announcement.

Recognizing Turiya not as an experience, but as the direction of the ground.

All this becomes life.

Meditation time will remain. Practice will remain. Study will remain. But outside of them also practice continues.

Practice spreads into life.

Life becomes practice.

Humility in freedom

A necessary fruit of freedom is humility.

If understanding is making the seeker hard, something is incomplete. If the seeker begins to look down on others and says, "I understand, they do not," then a subtle layer of Ahankar remains.

True glimpse brings humility.

Because the seeker sees how ancient the identification with body-mind is. The seeker knows that forgetfulness can arise again and again. Looking at the confusion of others, there is compassion, not mockery. One does not turn one's glimpse into a claim.

What became clear is grace.

What is still unclear is to be seen.

All seekers are walking in this direction.

Some move fast, some slowly.

Truth is not anyone's private property.

Humility does not mean making oneself small. Humility means not turning understanding into a wall of Ahankar.

Where freedom is real, humility is natural.

Compassion in freedom

With humility comes compassion.

When the seeker sees within oneself Ahankar, fear, grip, sorrow, the delicacy of the experiencer, and the power of story, others can be understood more deeply. One sees that everyone is moving within their own Avidya, story, longing, fear, and search.

Then the mistake of another does not only create anger. Clarity will remain, boundaries will remain, and if needed, firm action will also happen. But hatred inside becomes less.

Compassion is not blind agreement. Compassion does not mean calling the wrong right. Compassion means understanding the confusion of a person while remaining aligned with truth.

In the glimpse of Nirvan, compassion and clarity move together.

Where there is only compassion without clarity, one may drift.

Where there is only clarity without compassion, hardness may arise.

Where both are together, freedom matures.

Ordinary life in freedom

The glimpse of Nirvan does not separate the seeker from life. It makes the seeker more fully present in ordinary life.

Eating can be practice.

Listening to someone can be practice.

Accepting a mistake can be practice.

Apologizing can be practice.

Setting a boundary can be practice.

Completing work honestly can be practice.

Giving rest to a tired body can be practice.

Seeing a sorrowful mind with compassion can be practice.

When identity becomes light, even small acts of life carry a quiet dignity.

The seeker no longer waits only for big experiences. The direction of truth is seen in small moments too.

Nirvan is not far.

A glimpse of Nirvan can happen in this very moment - when the grip becomes a little loose.

Summary of this section

In this third section, we understood freedom while living in the world.

Freedom is not escape.

Freedom is the lightening of inner grip.

The experiencer remains in practical life, but becomes transparent.

Action continues, but doership becomes light.

Relationships remain, but grip becomes less.

Sorrow comes, but does not become final identity.

Happiness comes, but is not clung to.

Practice becomes natural.

Humility and compassion deepen.

Ordinary life itself becomes the field of practice.

This is the glimpse of Nirvan while living in the world.

In the final section, we will gather the whole journey of Nirvan Sutra. We will see the stream of all eight chapters together, and prepare the seeker for life, practice, review, and spiritual companionship - not as pressure, but as the next doorway.

Practice for today

Today choose one ordinary action from your life - cooking, working, speaking on the phone, listening to someone in the family, going to the shop, driving, writing, reading, or completing a small responsibility.

During that action, see three things:

Action is happening.

The experiencer says - I am doing.

Can doership become a little lighter?

Then do the action with full sincerity.

There is no need to slow down. No need to look special. Simply see within:

"Action is happening.

It is being known.

I am not merely the story of the doer."

Where action remains and grip becomes light, freedom while living begins.

Fourth Section - Beyond Nirvan Sutra

From the previous section: gathering the whole journey

In the previous section we saw that a glimpse of Nirvan is not in running away from the world. It is in the inner grip becoming light while living in the world. Action continues, but doership becomes light. Relationships remain, but grip becomes less. Sorrow comes, but it does not become final identity. Happiness comes, but it is not bound. Practice continues, but the image of the practitioner does not become heavy.

Now this is the final section.

Here we must gather not only one chapter, but the whole journey.

Nirvan Sutra has guided the seeker in a clear order. First the seeker looked at the self. Then the world was examined. Then Sakshi-bhav was brought into life. Then the layers of Ahankar were seen. Then Neti-neti made identifications light. Then the Mahavakyas were heard as direct pointers. Then Turiya was understood as the basis of states. And now, in the final chapter, the seeker is learning to recognize the glimpse of Nirvan in life.

But now comes a very subtle caution.

The seeker must not turn this whole journey into a new identity.

"I completed Nirvan Sutra."

"Now I have progressed."

"I am a special seeker."

"I have understood."

"I belong to this path."

"I have the correct knowledge."

If this happens, the journey has formed a new layer. Therefore the spirit of this final section is this: live what has been understood, but do not turn it into a new identity.

The purpose of Nirvan Sutra is not to make you an expert in Nirvan Sutra. Its purpose is to bring you back to that simplicity within where grip loosens, seeing becomes clear, and life is lived in awareness.

The stream of the eight chapters

Now look quietly at the whole journey.

In the **first chapter - The Search for the Self**, the seeker asked: "Who am I?" The body was seen, the mind was seen, and the difference between the experiencer and Sakshi began to become clear. The first indication appeared that the seeker is not merely the body-mind.

In the **second chapter - Maya and the World**, the seeker turned outward. It became clear that the world feels real in experience and is important in practical life, but it is not the final truth. Maya shows one truth as many names and forms. The world is not to be rejected, but to be seen with right vision.

In the **third chapter - Sakshi-bhav in Depth**, the seeker saw that Sakshi-bhav is not only for meditation. It can be remembered in relationships, work, success and failure, and deep emotions. Sakshi-bhav is not separate from life; it is the art of returning in the middle of life.

In the **fourth chapter - Layers of Ahankar**, the seeker saw that Ahankar is not only pride. It can form identity from body-mind, role, image, story, spiritual experience, and even the idea "I know." Ahankar is not to be fought. It is to be seen.

In the **fifth chapter - Neti-neti**, the seeker learned that whatever changes and whatever is known cannot be the final "I." Not the body, not the mind, not emotion, not role, not story, not spiritual identity. This is not rejection; it is the cleaning of identity.

In the **sixth chapter - Mahavakyas**, the seeker heard: Tat Tvam Asi, Aham Brahmasmi, Ayam Atma Brahma, Prajnanam Brahma. These statements showed that Sakshi, Atma, consciousness, and Brahman are not separate objects, but pointers to the same truth.

In the **seventh chapter - The Turiya State**, the seeker examined waking, dream, and deep sleep. It became clear that Turiya is not a fourth coming-and-going state, but the basis of the three states. The seeker also understood the subtle point of the unknowable - that which the mind cannot grasp as an object because it is the basis of all knowing.

In the **eighth chapter - A Glimpse of Nirvan**, the seeker has seen that Nirvan is not a distant achievement. It is the glimpse of the quieting of wrong grip. It is not leaving life, but becoming light in the midst of life. It is not the end of experiences, but the loosening of the hard identity built around them.

This is the stream of Nirvan Sutra.

This stream is not here to trap you in a doctrine. It is here to teach you how to relate rightly even to doctrine.

The last grip: "I must become free"

Now look at a very subtle point.

The seeker becomes a little free from worldly grip. Then the seeker may enter the grip of the spiritual path. Then the seeker says, "I must become free."

At the beginning this sentence is useful. The search begins. Practice begins. A question awakens. But after a point, "I must become free" can also become a grip.

Who wants freedom?

If the experiencer says, "I want a great experience," see it.

If Ahankar says, "I will become special by becoming free," see it.

If the mind says, "Once freedom comes, my story will be complete," see it.

If the spiritual image says, "I should be seen as free," see it.

In the direction of Nirvan, this too is seen.

The desire for freedom need not be suppressed. At the beginning of the search, it may be sacred. But in the end, this desire too must become light. Because the truth being sought is not a future object. It is already present in the direction of knowing. It is not separate from your being.

Therefore, in the final step, the seeker also sees:

"I want Nirvan" - this desire is also being known.

"I want an experience" - this too is being known.

"I want proof" - this too is being known.

"I want the final answer" - this too is being known.

That which knows all this is the doorway.

Completing Nirvan Sutra is not the end

With this chapter, the first great journey of the course becomes complete. But this is not the end.

Two mistakes are possible here.

The first mistake - the seeker thinks that because all chapters have been read, everything is complete.

The second mistake - the seeker thinks that so much still remains and becomes discouraged.

Both are to be avoided.

Reading was necessary. Understanding was necessary. Practice was necessary. Words gave direction. But now the real work is to see in life.

When someone criticizes, Nirvan Sutra must become alive.

When sorrow arises, Sakshi-bhav must be remembered.

When success comes, a layer of Ahankar must be seen.

When an experience comes in practice, the experiencer must be given its right place.

When the world feels heavy, Maya and Turiya must be remembered.

When "I know" arises, Neti-neti must come gently.

When a suffering person appears, compassion must awaken.

If this does not enter life, the words are still on the surface.

If it begins to enter small moments, the journey is alive.

Therefore completing Nirvan Sutra is not an end; it is entry into life.

Review: not a barrier, but a mirror

The review or examination after this course should not be seen with fear. It is not punishment. It is not a way to make the seeker small or big. It is like the next doorway.

The purpose is not only to check whether the words are remembered. It is also to see whether the direction has been understood. Is the difference between Sakshi and the experiencer clear? Is the distinction between Maya and Avidya understood? Has Ahankar been understood as more than pride? Has Neti-neti not been misunderstood as life-denial? Have the Mahavakyas not become declarations of ego? Has Turiya not been mistaken for an experience-state? Has Nirvan been understood not as achievement, but as the quieting of grip?

The review will be a mirror for the journey.

If something is clear, good.

If something is unclear, that is also good - now there is an opportunity to see.

If an answer is wrong, it is not failure; it is a sign for learning.

If there is confusion, that becomes the next subject of practice.

The Guru's review also means direction, not punishment.

Entry into the private group also means companionship, not specialness.

Whoever moves ahead must remember: entering the group is not a reward for Ahankar. It is an opportunity to deepen practice. There too the same practice continues - listening, seeing, questioning, living the teaching, and recognizing one's grip.

Group: companionship, not identity

If the seeker enters a private group later, one more caution must be kept.

Do not make identity out of the group.

"I am inside, others are outside" - this is Ahankar.

"I passed the review, so I am ahead" - this is Ahankar.

"I am a special seeker" - this too is identity.

The right meaning of group is companionship. To be with those who also want to look in the same direction. There is support, dialogue, practice, questions, and mutual remembering.

The purpose of companionship is awakening.

The purpose is not building group-image.

If the group makes you more humble, more honest, more aware, and more compassionate, it is moving in the right direction. If the group begins to make you feel special, separate, superior, or above others, see immediately: Ahankar has worn a new garment.

The direction of Nirvan makes every identity lighter, even spiritual identity.

How should practice continue?

Now that the journey of eight chapters is being completed, the seeker may ask, "What should I do next?"

Nothing very complicated.

See again and again.

Return again and again.

Become light again and again.

Wake up in the morning - see, the waking state is being known.

Work during the day - see, action is happening, doership is arising.

Speak in relationships - see, is there listening or reaction?

When sorrow arises - see, is it becoming a story?

When happiness comes - see, is grip forming?

Practice - see, is there hunger for experience?
Read words - see, is identity forming from words?
When silence comes - see, is silence being held?

All this is very ordinary. But depth is hidden in the ordinary.

Nirvan is not the name of an extraordinary life.
Nirvan is the direction in which wrong grip quiets in ordinary life.

One final point: join knowledge with love

If the heart has not become softer through this journey, something is incomplete.

Knowledge should not remain dry thought. Sakshi-bhav should not become merely standing apart and watching. Neti-neti should not become mere negation. Turiya should not remain theory. Nirvan should not remain only a word.

The fruit of all this should be clarity and compassion.

Compassion toward yourself.
Compassion toward others.
Sensitivity toward the body.
Patience toward the mind.
Honesty toward emotions.
Listening in relationships.
Truth in action.
Humility in practice.

If your understanding is making you hard, pause and see.
If your clarity makes you feel above others, pause and see.
If your Sakshi-bhav makes you insensitive, pause and see.
If your knowledge is separating from love, pause and see.

In the true direction, knowledge and love do not move separately.

Where clarity is present, compassion should deepen.
Where compassion is present, the strength to see confusion clearly should also be present.

In the glimpse of Nirvan, both come together.

The final essence of Nirvan Sutra

If the whole Nirvan Sutra is expressed as one simple stream, it is this:

You are not the body, but honor the body.
You are not the mind, but understand the mind.
You are not completely limited by the experiencer, but give the experiencer its right place in practical life.
You are not Ahankar, but do not fight Ahankar - see it.
The world is Maya, but do not reject the world - live with right vision.
Practice Neti-neti, but do not run from life.
Listen to the Mahavakyas, but do not turn them into ego's claim.
Recognize Turiya, but do not make it an object of experience.
See the glimpse of Nirvan, but do not make it an achievement.

And finally:

Make identity light from whatever is being known.
Do not try to grasp the knower as an object.
Live in life.
Live with love.
Live with truth.
Live lightly.

This is the heart of Nirvan Sutra.

Final blessing

Dear seeker, this journey is not a race. Clarity does not come through hurry. Here, walking slowly is walking rightly.

Many times you will forget.
Many times reaction will happen.
Many times Ahankar will arise.
Many times the experiencer will create a story of sorrow.
Many times practice will feel heavy.
Many times it may feel, "I have understood nothing."

All this also is to be known.

Forgetfulness is being known.
Reaction is being known.
Ahankar is a known layer.
Confusion is an experience.
"I do not know" is also being known.

So do not be discouraged.

Return each time.

Become a little lighter each time.

Give a little more space to truth in life each time.

Nirvan is not a prize standing far away.

Nirvan is the glimpse of the moment where grip becomes a little quiet, where the hardness of "I" melts a little, where life remains as it is but the light of seeing is lit within.

The journey will continue.

But now you are not walking in darkness.

A lamp of seeing has been lit within you.

Do not grasp it.

Do not make it your claim.

Simply learn to live in its light.

Final practice for this week

For the next seven days, keep the whole Nirvan Sutra as a simple practice in life.

Once a day, pause and ask:

What did I identify with today?

The body?

The mind?

An emotion?

A role?

A story?

Ahankar?

Spiritual understanding?

The idea of Nirvan?

Then ask a second question:

Can I see it without suppressing it and without making it my final nature?

Then ask a third question:

Where did a little lightness appear today?

Do not search for a big answer.

See the small moments.

A pause.

An honest seeing.

A little less reaction.

A moment of compassion.

A grip becoming loose.

A soft glimpse of silence in an ordinary moment.

That is enough.

At the end, gently say:

"What is being known is not what I finally am.

The knower is not to be grasped.

Life is to be lived with love.

Grip is to be allowed to become light."

This is the completion of Nirvan Sutra.

This is the glimpse of Nirvan.

This is the beginning of the journey ahead.